SALIM SHRESTHA

WordPress Plugin Engineer

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PROFILE

Product-focused WordPress Plugin Engineer with **3.5+ years of experience** building and maintaining production plugins used by 10K - 60K+ active installations. Strong expertise in **plugin architecture, API integrations, performance optimization, security hardening** and **clean code**. Experienced working in **remote**, asynchronous teams with full lifecycle ownership from feature design to release.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Lead Plugin Developer – WPCenter (Remote) **(May 2025 – February 2026)**

- Led development and maintenance of **AffiliateX** and **eRoom** (10K+ active installs each), owning feature planning, architectural refactoring, and release cycles.
- Executed major architectural refactor by replacing legacy NUXY dependency with a custom lightweight settings framework, improving maintainability and reducing dependency complexity.
- Built dynamic Gutenberg blocks with **complex rendering logic** and **structured data handling**.
- Developed a **complete Elementor widget library** mirroring 20+ Gutenberg blocks to expand cross-builder compatibility.
- Implemented geolocation-based dynamic routing for Amazon affiliate URLs using structured logic and conditional processing.
- Identified and patched critical security vulnerabilities (SQL injection, XSS, authorization bypass) through strict sanitization, escaping, nonce verification, and capability checks.
- Improved proxy API system using batch processing and background scheduling for handling large external requests.
- Standardized PHPCS and ESLint workflows across the codebase, improving long-term maintainability.
- Collaborated asynchronously with team members through GitHub pull requests, code reviews, and documentation.

WordPress Plugin Developer - ThemeGrill **(June 2022 – January 2024)**

- Contributed production features to **User Registration, Everest Forms,** and **BlockArt Blocks** (200K+ active installs combined).
- Designed and built **Two-Factor Authentication add-on** using secure token validation and authentication flow design.
- Developed **Advanced Analytics addon** for Everest Forms including tracking logic and React-based data visualization interface.
- Built Gutenberg blocks and contributed to global settings architecture using modern JS tooling.
- Managed release cycles including version bumps, changelogs and testing.
- Integrated external APIs and webhooks for analytics and form processing workflows.
- Mentored junior developers and conducted code reviews focused on WordPress Coding Standards and OOP best practices.

Fellow – Teach for Nepal **(January 2024 – December 2024)**

- Completed intensive leadership training focused on communication, systems thinking, and stakeholder management.
- Taught Computer Science to 120+ students in a rural public school, designing structured curriculum and managing classroom operations.
- Developed leadership, conflict resolution, and project planning skills in resource-constrained environments.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Plugin Architecture:** WordPress plugin architecture, Hooks, Gutenberg blocks, Elementor Widgets, Action Scheduler, WooCommerce Integrations, WordPress REST API
- **Languages:** PHP (OOP), HTML5, CSS3/SCSS, JavaScript (ES6+), React, TypeScript, jQuery, SQL
- **Tools:** Node, Webpack, Babel, Gulp, Composer, PHPCS, ESLint, WP-CLI, Git/GitHub
- **Performance:** Database Optimization, Caching Strategies, Background Processing, Query Optimization
- **Security:** Nonce Verification, Capability checks, Sanitization, Escaping
- **AI:** Cursor, Claude Code
- **Others:** API Integration, Batch Processing, Webhook Integration, Testing, Debugging, Code Review

COMMUNITY

- WordCamp Bharatpur 2025 Speaker
- WordPress.org Plugin Author
- WordPress Translation Contributor
- WordCamp Kathmandu 2023 Participant

REMOTE WORK EXPERIENCE

- 1 year worked in distributed teams in Nepal and Turkey
- Comfortable with asynchronous communication and written documentation
- Experienced in GitHub-based collaboration and pull request workflows
- Regular participation in sprint planning, code reviews, and feature discussions

EDUCATION

B. Sc. Computer Science & Information Technology **(2017 - 2022)**

Tribhuvan University